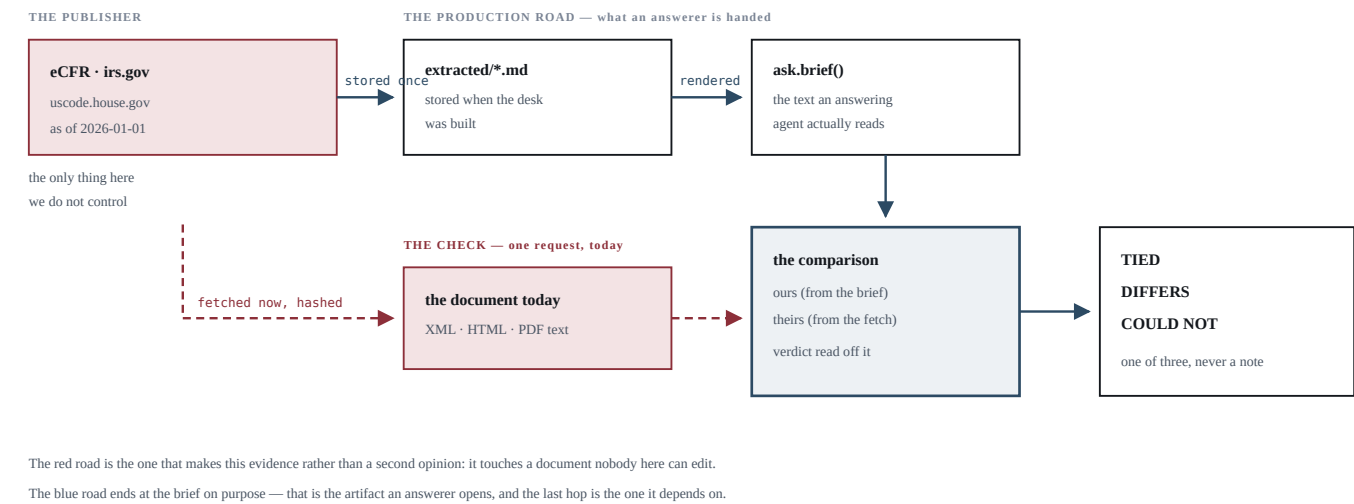


vehicle-expense

Every passage this desk hands to an answering agent, put back to the publisher that wrote it.

The question is not whether our tests pass. It is whether the authority we serve is what the authority actually says — which no test in this repository can answer, because they all read the same stored files.



The same passage, two roads. They meet at the comparison, and the verdict is read off that block rather than written ahead of it.

The roster

0	0	129 of 129	4
DIFFERS	COULD NOT	TIED	SOURCES FETCHED LIVE

Of the **129** that tied, **129** matched the publisher's characters exactly and **0** matched only once whitespace was ignored — which is declared, and explained under what this does not prove.

The sample of one, worked end to end

The longest passage on this desk, because a long one has the most places to be wrong.

1 · THE FIGURE — AND WHERE A READER SEES IT

Not a row of a database: the paragraph of authority the desk hands an answering agent under the citation 26 CFR 1.280F-6(f)(2)(iii). It is read out of ask.brief(), which is the text that agent opens, and it is 1,616 characters long.

A pre-effective date vehicle will be treated, to the extent provided in this paragraph (f)(2)(iii), as property to which section 280F(a) does not apply if the taxpayer adopts that treatment on an amended Federal tax return in accordance with this paragraph (f)(2)(iii). This paragraph (f)(2)(iii) applies only if, on or before December 31, 2004, the taxpayer files, for all applicable taxable years, amended Federal tax returns (or qualified amended returns, if applicable (for further guidance, see Rev. Proc. 94-69 (1994-2 C.B. 804) and § 601.601(d)(2)(ii)(b) of this chapter)) treating the vehicle as property to which section 280F(a) does not apply. The applicable taxable years for this purpose are the taxable year in which the vehicle was placed in service by the taxpayer (or, if the period of limitation for assessment under section 6501 has expired for such year or any subsequent year (a closed year), the first taxable year following the most recent closed year) and all subsequent taxable years in which the vehicle was treated on the taxpayer's return as property to which section 280F(a) applies. If the earliest applicable taxable year is not the year in which the vehicle was placed in service, the adjusted depreciable basis of the property as of the beginning of the first applicable taxable year is recovered over the remaining recovery period. If the remaining recovery period as of the beginning of the first applicable taxable year is less than 12 months, the entire adjusted depreciable basis of the property as of the beginning of the first applicable taxable year is recovered in that year.

2 · THE CALL — COPY-PASTABLE, WITH THE REAL VALUES IN IT

```
curl -sS --compressed "https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-01-01/title-26.xml?section=1.280F-6"
```

Fetchd 2026-09-06 02:23:15Z · 21,207 bytes · SHA-256
45d6178b90f790064b3e6d445266a29cecf800bc503c55f55cad5ac17f9521de

3 · THE DERIVATION — WHAT HAPPENS BETWEEN THE TWO

The response is turned into plain text: an XML or HTML document has its inline tags closed up and its block tags turned into a space, a PDF is read page by page. Both sides are then folded the same way — Unicode normalised, and the typographic quotes and dashes publishers vary between renderings mapped to their plain forms. **Nothing else is changed.** The stored text either occurs in the publisher's document or it does not.

4 · THE INDEPENDENT SOURCE — CAPTURED, NOT SUMMARISED

The publisher's own words around the match, quoted verbatim out of the bytes whose hash is printed above. **A reader re-fetches that URL, recomputes the hash, and gets the same digits** — which is a check a photograph cannot offer.

...payer's original return for the year in which the vehicle is placed in service. (iii) A pre-effective date vehicle will be treated, to the extent provided in this paragraph (f)(2)(iii), as property to which section 280F(a) does not apply if the taxpayer adopts that treatment on an amended Federal tax return in accordance with this paragraph (f)(2)(iii). This paragraph (f)(2)(iii) applies only if, on or before December 31, 2004, the taxpayer files, for all applicable taxable years, amended Federal tax returns (or qualified amended returns, if applicable (for further guidance, see Rev. Proc. 94-69 (1994-2 C.B. 804) and § 601.601(d)(2)(ii)(b) of this chapter)) treating the vehicle as property to which section 280F(a) does not apply. The applicable taxable years for this purpose are the taxable year in which the vehicle was placed in service by the taxpayer (or, if the period of limitation for assessment under section 6501 has expired for such year or any subsequent year (a closed year), the first taxable year following the most recent closed year) and all subsequent taxable years in which the vehicle was treated on the taxpayer's return as property to which section 280F(a) applies. If the earliest applicable taxable year is not the year in which the vehicle was placed in service, the adjusted depreciable basis of the property as of the beginning of the first applicable taxable year is recovered over the remaining recovery period. If the remaining recovery period as of the beginning of the first applicable taxable year is less than 12 months, the entire adjusted depreciable basis of the property as of the beginning of the first applicable taxable year is recovered in that year. (iv) A pre-effective date vehicle will be treated, to the extent provided in this paragraph (f)(2)(iv), as property to which section 280F(a) does not apply if the taxpayer adopts that treatment on Form 3115, Application for Change in Accounting Method, in acc...

5 · THE COMPARISON

ours (ask.brief → 26 CFR 1.280F-6(f)(2)(iii))
1,616 characters
theirs (https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-01-01/ti)
1,616 of them found, verbatim, in the document fetched above
diff none

TIED — the publisher’s characters exactly

Every passage on this desk

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(a)	125	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(b)(1)	290	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(b)(6)	83	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(b)(6)(i)(A)	244	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(b)(6)(i)(B)	348	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(b)(6)(ii)	73	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(b)(6)(iii)	325	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(1)	1,556	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(2)(i)	718	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(2)(ii)	266	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(2)(ii)(A)	1,084	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(2)(ii)(B)	1,009	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(3)(i)	350	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(3)(ii)(A)	455	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(3)(ii)(B)	299	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(c)(4)	127	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.274-5T(d)(2)	629	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(a)(1)	373	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(a)(2)(i)	293	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(a)(2)(ii)	506	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(a)(3)	158	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(1)	109	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(1)(i)	71	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(1)(ii)	102	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(1)(iii)	98	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(1)(iv)	78	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(1)(v)	65	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(2)(i)	245	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(2)(ii)	157	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(3)	37	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(3)(i)	201	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(3)(ii)	300	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(3)(iii)	347	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(b)(5)	383	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(c)(1)	135	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(c)(1)(i)	74	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(c)(1)(ii)	51	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(c)(2)	318	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(c)(3)	84	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(c)(3)(i)	104	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(c)(3)(ii)	127	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(c)(3)(iii)	88	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(1)	181	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(i)	508	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(ii)(A)	62	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(ii)(A)(1)	58	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(ii)(A)(2)	115	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(ii)(A)(3)	286	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(ii)(B)	268	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(ii)(C)	44	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(ii)(C)(1)	154	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(2)(ii)(C)(2)	120	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(3)(i)	805	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(3)(ii)	281	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(3)(iii)	174	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(3)(iv)	219	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(3)(iv)(A)	56	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(3)(iv)(B)	130	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(3)(iv)(C)	41	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(4)(i)	199	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(d)(4)(ii)	147	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(e)(1)	254	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(e)(2)	486	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(e)(3)	518	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(f)(1)	361	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(f)(2)	345	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(f)(2)(i)	182	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(f)(2)(ii)	263	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(f)(2)(iii)	1,616	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.280F-6(f)(2)(iv)	1,071	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(b)	589	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(b)(1)	119	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(b)(2)	140	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(c)(1)	533	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(c)(2)(i)	249	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(c)(2)(ii)	461	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(c)(3)(i)	470	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(c)(3)(ii)	454	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(c)(4)	522	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(c)(5)	1,020	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(d)(1)	1,135	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(d)(2)	964	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(d)(3)(i)	418	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(d)(3)(ii)	908	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(e)(1)	295	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(e)(2)	1,381	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(e)(3)	712	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(f)	1,152	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(f)(2)	1,259	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(g)(1)	104	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(g)(2)(i)	331	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(g)(2)(ii)	741	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(g)(3)	451	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(h)(1)	831	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(h)(2)(i)(A)	929	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(h)(2)(i)(B)(1)	795	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(h)(2)(i)(B)(2)	581	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(h)(2)(i)(B)(3)	794	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(h)(2)(ii)	259	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(i)	448	exact
TIED	26 CFR 1.62-2(k)	257	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Accountable Plans"	1,494	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Accounting to Your Client"	648	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Actual Car Expenses"	432	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Adequate Accounting"	1,223	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Adequate evidence"	724	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Business and personal use"	197	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Car defined"	645	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Choosing the standard mileage rate"	1,076	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Deductible payments"	574	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Depreciation and section 179 deductions"	1,191	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Employer-provided vehicle"	216	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Five or more cars"	601	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Inclusion Amounts"	759	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Interest on car loans"	290	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Interest"	932	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Leasing a Car"	241	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Nonaccountable Plans"	935	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Parking fees and tolls"	207	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Per Diem and Car Allowances"	1,278	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Proving business purpose"	300	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Reimbursements"	604	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Sampling"	294	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Standard Mileage Rate"	718	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Standard mileage rate not allowed"	708	exact

VERDICT	CITATION	CHARS	HOW / WHY
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Table 5-1. How To Prove Certain Business Expenses – Transportation"	377	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "Timely kept records"	731	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "What Are Adequate Records?"	872	exact
TIED	IRS Pub. 463 (2025), "What if I Have Incomplete Records?"	1,055	exact

The sources, and that they can disagree with us

- **S1** — Treasury Regulation § 1.280F-6 — Special rules and definitions (listed property, business use percentage)
<https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-01-01/title-26.xml?section=1.280F-6>
- **S2** — Treasury Regulation § 1.62-2 — Reimbursements and other expense allowance arrangements
<https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-01-01/title-26.xml?section=1.62-2>
- **S3** — Treasury Regulation § 1.274-5T — Substantiation requirements (temporary)
<https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-01-01/title-26.xml?section=1.274-5T>
- **S4** — IRS Publication 463 (2025) — Travel, Gift, and Car Expenses
<https://www.irs.gov/publications/p463>

Not one of these is ours. None is a cache, a fixture or a second copy of our own record — which is the test the tie-out skill puts first: **could this disagree with me?** Each one can, and two of them did.

How to run this yourself

Every step below has the real values already in it. Nothing here needs me.

1 · RE-RUN THE WHOLE CHECK

```
cd desk && python -B tools/tieout.py
```

It fetches every source live and writes tie-outs/findings.json. Expect it to take a few minutes: it pauses between requests rather than hammering the publishers.

2 · REBUILD THESE DOCUMENTS FROM THAT RUN

```
cd desk && python -B tools/tieout_exhibit.py
```

3 · CHECK ONE LINE BY HAND, WITHOUT EITHER SCRIPT

Take any row in the roster, fetch its URL, and look for the text yourself:

```
curl -sS --compressed "https://www.ecfr.gov/api/versioner/v1/full/2026-01-01/title-26.xml?section=1.280F-6" | shasum -a 256
```

If that hash matches the one printed with the exemplar above, you are reading the same bytes this document read. Then search the document for the passage — the desk prints it under that citation in the brief:

```
cd desk && python -B -c "import sys; sys.path.insert(0, '.'); import ask, record, pathlib; \
print(ask.brief('show me', record.load(pathlib.Path('desks/vehicle-expense'))))" | less
```

What it found

Two differences in 533 passages, and a defect in the record that no difference would have shown.

- **Right text, wrong link — three passages.** The rewards desk stores § 6041, § 6041A, § 6050W and § 6071 under one source whose recorded URL is the House's granule for **§ 6041 only**. A reader following that link finds the first and not the other three; the "6041A" and "6050W" they see on that page are § 6041's own cross-references. All three bodies are **verbatim correct** on their own granules, so nothing served was wrong and no test could have caught it — the numbers were right and the citation pointed somewhere that does not carry them. **Only following the link finds this.** The checker now resolves each statute citation to its own granule; the record's source URL is still under-covering and is a fix for the desk.
- **A partial quotation that does not say it is one.** Publication 583's sentence has two branches and the cash desk stores the second without marking the omission. The split is right — the branches have opposite answers, which is the defect #264 found — but an answerer reading the passage cannot tell a branch was removed.
- **A publisher's interface text inside a quotation.** irs.gov appends the word **PDF** to links that point at PDFs, and it sits mid-sentence on the tangible-property page. Ours drops it, which reads correctly and is not what the page literally shows.

And what it did not find is the point of running it. 531 of 533 passages are, character for character, what the publisher publishes today. That was an assumption this morning and it is a measurement now.

What I got wrong

The first run reported 88 differences and 34 of them were mine. The extractor replaced every markup tag with a space, so eCFR's election</I>—(1) came back as election - (1) and 601.601(d)(2)(ii)(<I>b</I>) as (b). A checker that invents differences is worse than no checker, because somebody goes and "fixes" the record to match it. Inline tags now close up and only block tags become a space.

Then it reported 18, and 16 of those were mine too. pypdf reads a kerned two-column IRS page as Y ou and hyphenates infor-mation across a line break, and irs.gov puts block markup inside a sentence. Those are rendering artefacts of the extractor, not differences in what was published — so the comparison now runs twice, and the exhibit says which pass carried each line rather than quietly folding them together.

I could not capture the sources as photographs, and the skill asks for photographs.

This machine's browser cannot reach the publishers even when pointed at the egress proxy

— ERR_CONNECTION_RESET — while the HTTP client reaches them fine. Attempted, failed, recorded. What is here instead is the document itself: its SHA-256, its length, the moment it was fetched and the publisher's own words quoted around each match. For text that is the stronger evidence, because a reader can recompute the hash and a screenshot cannot be re-verified at all.

What this does not prove

- **It proves the words, not the reading.** That § 1.263(a)-1(f)(1)(ii)(D) says \$500 is now established. Whether \$500 is the number that governs a client is a question about Notice 2015-82 and about the firm's election, and no fetch settles it.
- **It proves containment, not completeness.** The check asks whether our passage occurs in the publisher's document. It does not ask whether we stored the *whole* of what that citation covers — a passage could be a true fragment of a paragraph whose second half changes its meaning. Publication 583 above is exactly that failure caught by accident, not by design.
- **The whitespace-ignoring pass can hide a genuinely missing space.** 13 lines tied only on that pass. Each is named in the roster as spacing so nobody has to take it on trust.
- **The regulations were fetched as of 2026-01-01, not today.** eCFR's versioner refuses a future date and this is the last date known good on it. A regulation amended between that date and now would not show here.
- **One reading, not two.** The skill asks for a second rendering where one exists — the XML and the rendered page, the PDF and the HTML. Only one rendering per source was read. A digit or a word wrong in *both* our copy and the one rendering we read would pass.
- **Nothing here touches whether a desk answers well.** This is about the authority it is given. A desk with a perfect corpus can still reason badly from it, and that is what the scoreboard is for.